



Facebook and Google have a stalker!

An Australian antitrust body is watching Facebook and Google to monitor the platform's violent content. <https://dgit.in/aug19-69>



PUBG Lite launched in India

PUBG Lite on mobile has launched in India and is designed for phones with less than 2GB RAM. <https://dgit.in/aug19-70>

Jabra Elite 85H

A worthy contender from Jabra, but not the best in the category

When you think of a solid pair of wireless ANC (Active Noise Cancellation) headphones, two names instantly come to mind - Bose and Sony with the QC 35 II and the Sony WH 1000XM3. However, this year Jabra treated us to their own rendition of this class of products with the wireless, ANC-enabled Jabra Elite 85H. Priced at ₹28,999, the Jabra Elite 85H seems to hold a lot of promise. Let's figure out if Jabra's pitch is really worth listening to here.

Build and Design

The Jabra Elite 85H are made out of plastic with a fabric coating on the outside and faux leather on the underside of the headband and over the earcups. The earcups are exceptionally soft and foam-cushioned for additional comfort. Jabra claims that these headphones are splash resistant. The earcups on the headphones can be swivelled around. Swivelling the earcups into to face each other will turn them on, automatically, while turning them down will switch them off.

Controls and Features

On the right earcup, you will find three tactile buttons. The button in the middle will allow you to pause and play music and answer calls. The other two buttons will let you control the volume and skip tracks. At the bottom of the right-side earcup there's a button that will fire up your voice assistant. The left side has one button which allows users to cycle through ANC modes - ANC on, Hear Through, or off. There's also a USB-C port and a 3.5mm jack.

When you turned on, the cans will connect to the paired Bluetooth device immediately. We experienced no issues while pairing and connecting our device.



Price
₹28,999



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Jabra also has auto pause and play which sense when you have taken the cans off and put them back on. In terms of ANC functionality, the headphones offer an array of modes, referred to as 'Moments' which include Commute, In Private, In

Public, and ANC off. For each Moment, you can manually set an ANC profile. For example, we used Hear Through for Public mode so that we could hear traffic on the road and announcements at the train station. Jabra has also implemented an "intelligent adaptive technology", an AI which adjusts ANC modes depending on your surroundings. Jabra calls this feature SmartSound. This mode, while useful, has some kinks in the current stage.

Performance

The headphones sport good bass, slightly above neutral. However, you will find similarly or slightly-higher priced ANC headphones that produce deeper and punchier bass. You can change the EQ settings in the app though.

In *Pull me Under* by *Dream Theatre*, the drumming in the song has a good amount of bass without sacrificing the clarity and hearability of the array of instruments playing alongside. Mid and

high frequencies sound fantastic on the Jabra Elite 85H and vocals are exceptionally crisp. The audio signature is generally brighter than the Bose QC 35 II and Sony WH 1000XM3, however, not to a point where you will get fatigued easily.

The audio separation is also excellent but soundstage isn't perfect. ANC is very good on the device but doesn't quite blow its competitors out of the water. Call-quality on the headphones is stellar. However, audio purists may be alarmed by the fact that these headphones do not support high-end audio codecs such as AAC, aptX or LDAC.

Battery

The battery life on these headphones are perhaps the best in the wireless, ANC headphones category. The cans provide you with a whopping 36 hours of battery life with ANC turned on and a staggering 41 hours with ANC turned off, which is ludicrous really. In our tests, at around 50% volume, we got around 34 hours and 20 minutes of ON time.

Jabra Elite 85H Verdict

The Jabra Elite 85H boasts exceptional battery life, great design and is a worthy contender in this category. Features like auto-pause and play, powering on and off the headphones using the earcups, custom EQ modes and splash resistance set these cans apart from. However, its competitors such as Sony and Bose offer a more satisfying "bass-y" experience. Some audio purists may also be turned off by the fact that these pair of cans lack support for high-end codecs. However, if you are looking for a good pair of wireless ANC headphones, you cannot go wrong with the Jabra Elite 85H, particularly since it is priced slightly lower than its competitors too.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

WEIGHT: 296 g | NUMBER OF MICROPHONES: 8 | VOICE ASSISTANT ACCESS: Yes (one-touch access) | ADAPTIVE AUDIO: Yes (with SmartSound) | ON-EAR DETECTION: Yes | BATTERY LIFE: Up to 41 hours (with ANC off) / up to 36 hours (with ANC on) | CHARGING TIME: 2.5 hours | CHARGING PLUG: USB-C | CONNECTION: Bluetooth 5.0, USB-C, 3.5 mm jack | OPERATING RANGE: Up to 10 m (33 ft)

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